

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

AI & Academic Integrity: Setting Clear Expectations with Students

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session in which every teacher writes the AI rules for a real upcoming assignment, in student language, and practices a fair process for suspected misuse. Run by your own coach or teacher-leader; no consultant required.

THE STANCE, AND YOUR PARENT ANSWER

Clarity beats policing. Every assignment states its AI rules in writing, honesty is taught like a skill, and no student is ever accused based on an AI-detector score alone.

Why this matters now

54% of teens use AI for schoolwork (Pew, 2026) while guidance lags far behind adoption (RAND, 2025), so most students are guessing at the rules. Stanford's before-and-after surveys found self-reported cheating flat at 60–70% across ChatGPT's arrival (Lee, Pope et al., 2024): the integrity problem predates the bot, and clarity, not panic, is the fix. Meanwhile the detector route carries real risk: OpenAI shut down its own AI-text detector for low accuracy, and peer-reviewed research found commercial detectors flagged over half of essays by real non-native English speakers as AI-generated (Liang et al., 2023). A false accusation is a family, a lawyer, and a headline. This session replaces scores with process.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Label every assignment with one of three AI lanes: AI-free, AI-assisted, or AI-included
- Print an AI-expectation box on assignments, in language students can quote back
- Teach a two-line disclosure norm that makes honest AI use visible and coachable
- Design assignments where the thinking is visible: drafts, local anchors, live defenses
- Run a curiosity-first conversation for suspected misuse, built on process evidence
- State the red line cold: no accusation on a detector score alone, ever

Research base in brief

Cheating rates stable pre/post ChatGPT: Lee, Pope, Miles, & Zárate (2024) · Why students cheat: Stanford GSE / Challenge Success · Teen AI use: Pew Research Center (2026) · Adoption vs. guidance gap: RAND RR-A4180-1 (2025) · Detector unreliability: OpenAI (2023) · Detector bias against non-native writers: Liang et al., *Patterns* (2023) · Integrity framework: International Center for Academic Integrity (2021). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 5 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**, the student-facing counterpart to Kit 4's assessment work. Ships with a 30-day plan (three 10-minute PLC follow-ups ending in student co-written classroom agreements, no new meetings) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Kit 6 (AI for Communication) is next.